

User Manual

Produced by Team 5 as part of SENG202 2026

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Introduction

What is Route Beer?

Route beer is a desktop application that generates routes between multiple bars. Instead of planning a night out by hand, you can tell the app what you want from your bar crawl and builds the route for you. You can save routes to an online account, share them with others, and export them as an image

Who is the manual for?

This manual is for all Christchurch residents and people visiting the city and are looking explore what the city has to offer. This can be friends or groups planning a night out, drinking or not. You do not need any technical knowledge, if you can navigate a website or phone app, you can use Route Beer.

How this manual is organised

This manual will take you through step by step instructions on how to use every feature in the app. It takes you through from starting the application to being able to confidently use Route Beer to its full extent.

Getting Started

When the app loads, you will be presented with an entry screen, as seen in Figure 1. This is an app entry barrier which ensures you are over the age of 18 years old. This is because the app relates to the consumption of alcohol which is against the law for under 18s. A response of ‘No’ will show a message that you must be over 18 to use the application, and will not let you proceed further into the app. A response of ‘Yes’ will proceed you to the login page.

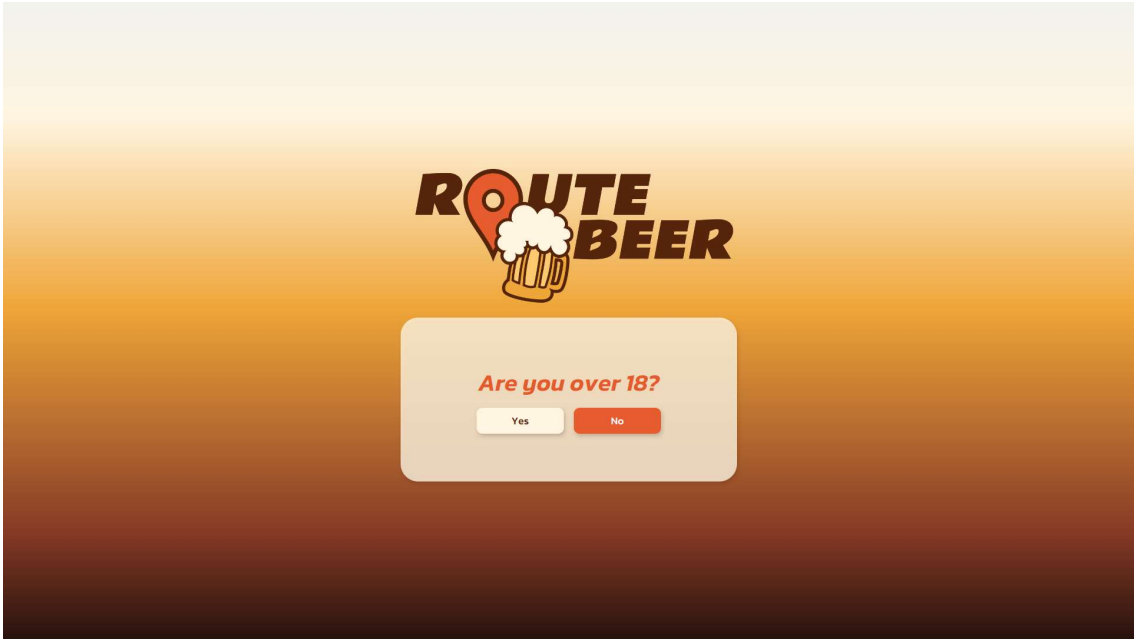


Figure 1 - Entry Screen to Route Beer application

Creating an account

Your next step to using the app will be to create an account. To do this, switch tabs from the ‘Sign In’ to the ‘Create Account’ tab as seen in Figure 2. Here you will be able to create your very own account. Enter a username, password and confirm your password. It is important you do not use any real credentials. Although your information is securely stored and password encrypted, we at Route Beer ask you to be creative with your credentials and make some fake ones up. You will have to conform to the username and password restrictions below:

- Username:
    - Must be from 5 to 16 characters (Inclusive)
    - May not contain spaces, underscores, or periods
    - Unique to other Route Beer users
- Password
    - Must be from 8 to 16 characters (Inclusive)
    - May only contain letters, numbers, and any of !@#$%^&*

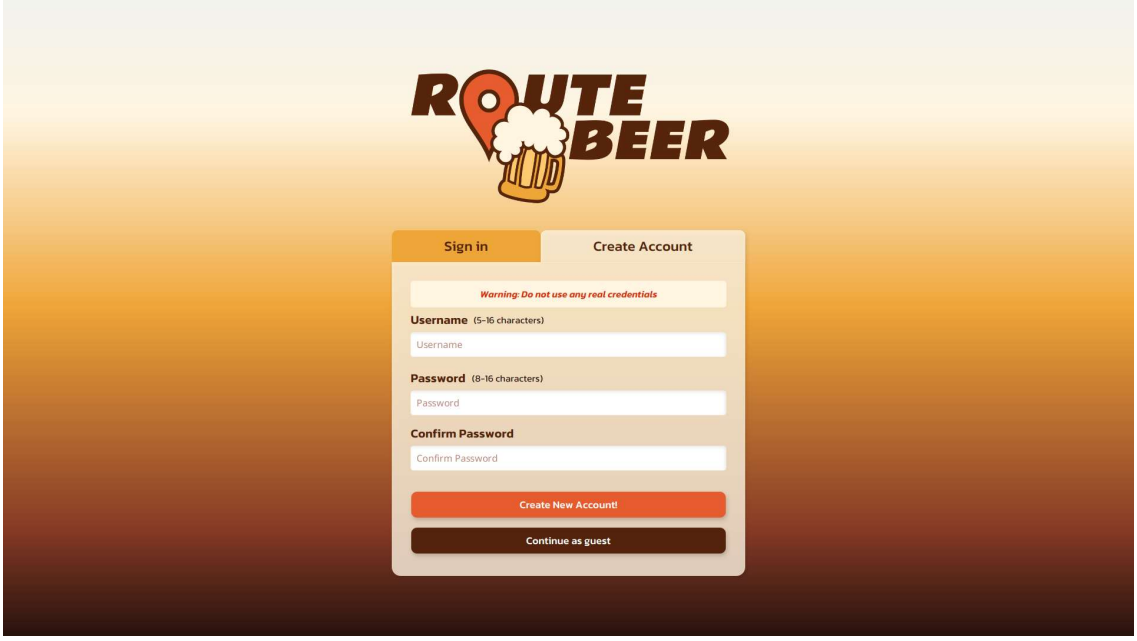


Figure 2 - Create Account screen

Once you have put all your credentials in, click ‘Create New Account!’. If all your info is correct, your account will be created and you will be taken to the main screen of the application. If not, you will have to try again. There will be bold, red, error text communicating the error to you which will be easy to understand. Then, try again until you succeed in creating an account.

When using Route Beer again, you will be able to sign in using your username and password. This will allow you to see your saved routes any time you want.

At any point if you forget your details or don't want to create an account, you will still be able to access the application. Just click 'Continue as guest' and it will take you to the application.

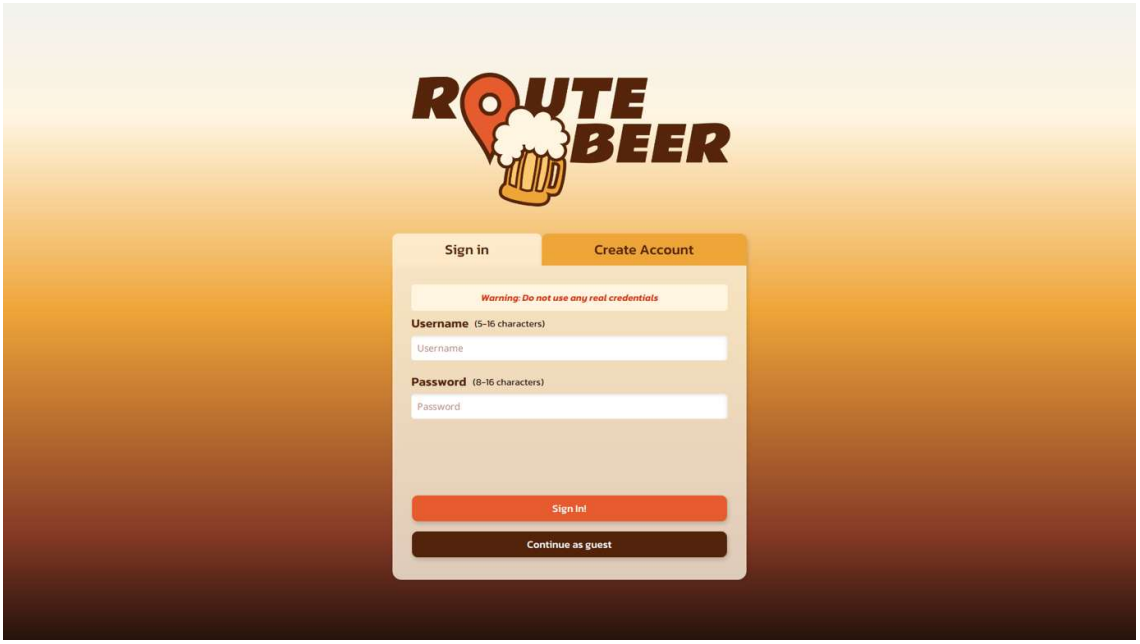


Figure 3: Sign-in screen

Generate a route

After creating an account, signing in, or continuing as guest, you will be greeted by the main screen. On the left is the tab pane containing:

- Route Builder (default)
  Generate a route based on chosen parameters
- Route Details
  Generated or loaded route's additional details can be viewed
- Saved Routes
  Your own personal routes
- Public Routes
  Published routes that anyone can view

At the bottom is the account management section where you can

- If signed in: sign out or delete account
- If guest: sign in

Clicking on any of these tabs will display the expanded tab.

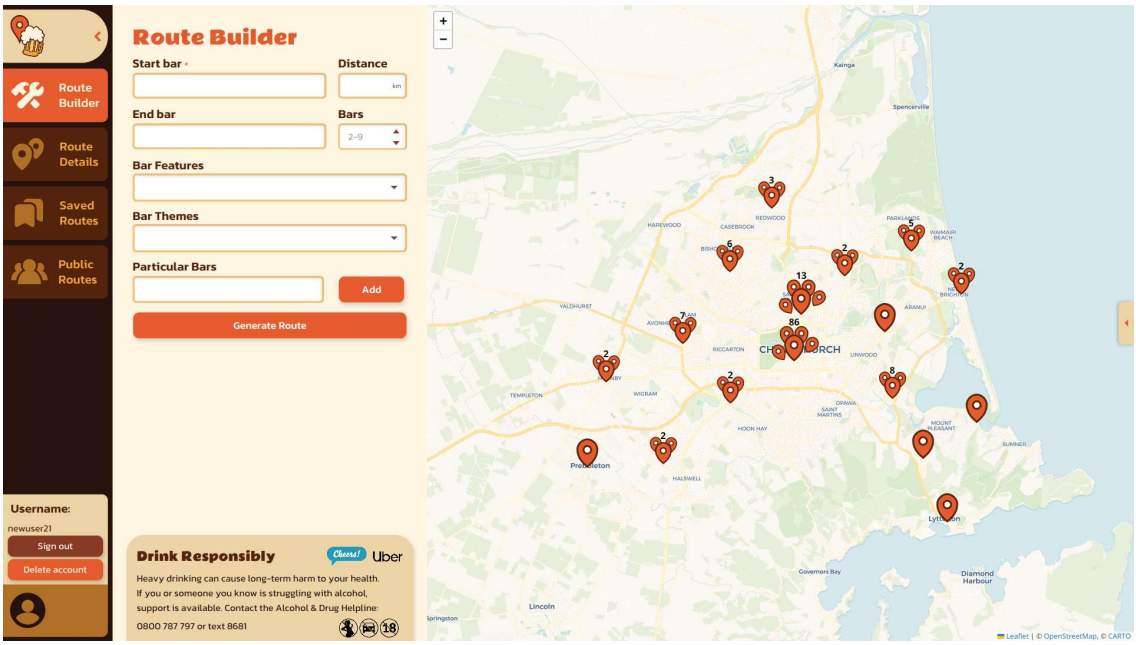


Figure 4: Main screen

Route Builder

The Route Builder tab is the default tab, see Figure 5.

On the right side is the map where you can zoom and pan. The pins on the map represent bars in Christchurch, a cluster of pins represents a group of bars close together – clicking on them will zoom closer to separate them. Clicking on an individual bar will display information about it on a further right panel including name, description, opening hours, theme, and features.

At the top is the set of parameters you can choose to customise your route:

- Start bar *(required)*, the bar to start the route at
- End bar, the bar to finish the route at
- Distance, the approximate distance (km) the route will be
- Bars, the number of bars the route will visit
- Bar Features, any features the route should include e.g. Pool Table
- Bar Themes, any themes the route should include e.g. Irish Pub
- Particular Bars, any particular bars the route should include
    - Search for a bar then click ‘Add’ to add it to the parameters
    - Click the minus button to remove it from the parameters

Each parameter chosen will help determine the route that is generated. Any parameters left empty, other than start bar, will be randomly chosen by the algorithm.

After selecting your chosen parameters, the algorithm will generate a route, display it on the map, and take you to the route details screen.

The drink responsibly section has numbers to call and text and a link to the Cheers.org website; if you are struggling with alcohol, support is available through these. A link to the download Uber app website is also able to be clicked.

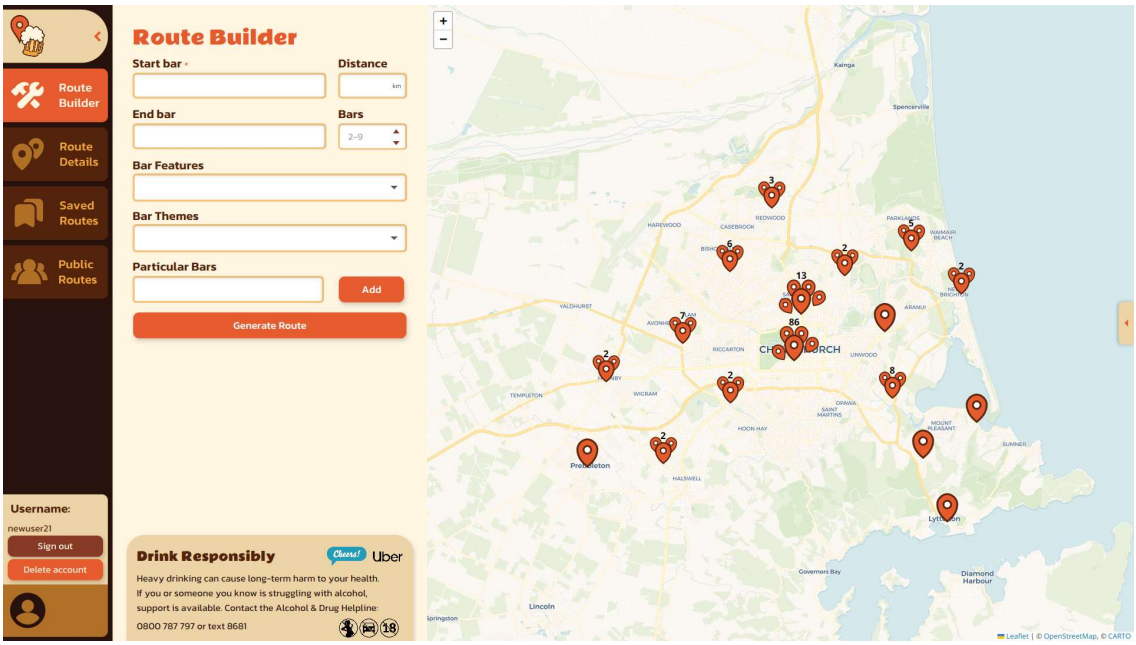


Figure 5: Route Builder tab

Save, load, delete, publish routes

The Route Details tab in Figure 6 will show additional details about a route that you have generated or loaded.

The map shows the bars the route visits with a small number showing when in the route it is visited along with a line showing the path. The additional icons represent fast food restaurants, public toilets, and drinking fountains. The key in the top left can be used to toggle these amenities to show or hide.

On the left panel, you are able to type a name for the route with a description (optional) and save it to your account by pressing the yellow ‘Save Route’ button. You won’t be able to save a route if you already have a route of the same name.

If this route you are viewing is one you generated yourself, the ‘Regenerate Route’ button will be displayed, which will use the same parameters to generate another route.

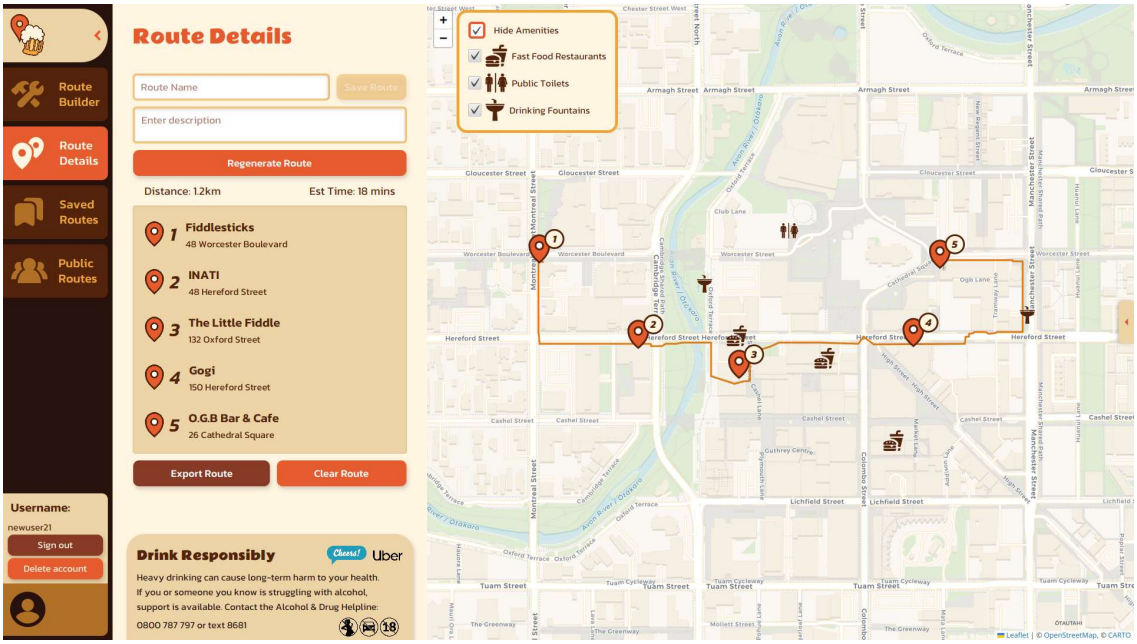


Figure 6: Route Details tab

Clicking on a bar at any point, with a route shown or not, will show a panel on the right side. This will show additional information about the bar – name, description, theme, opening hours, and features.

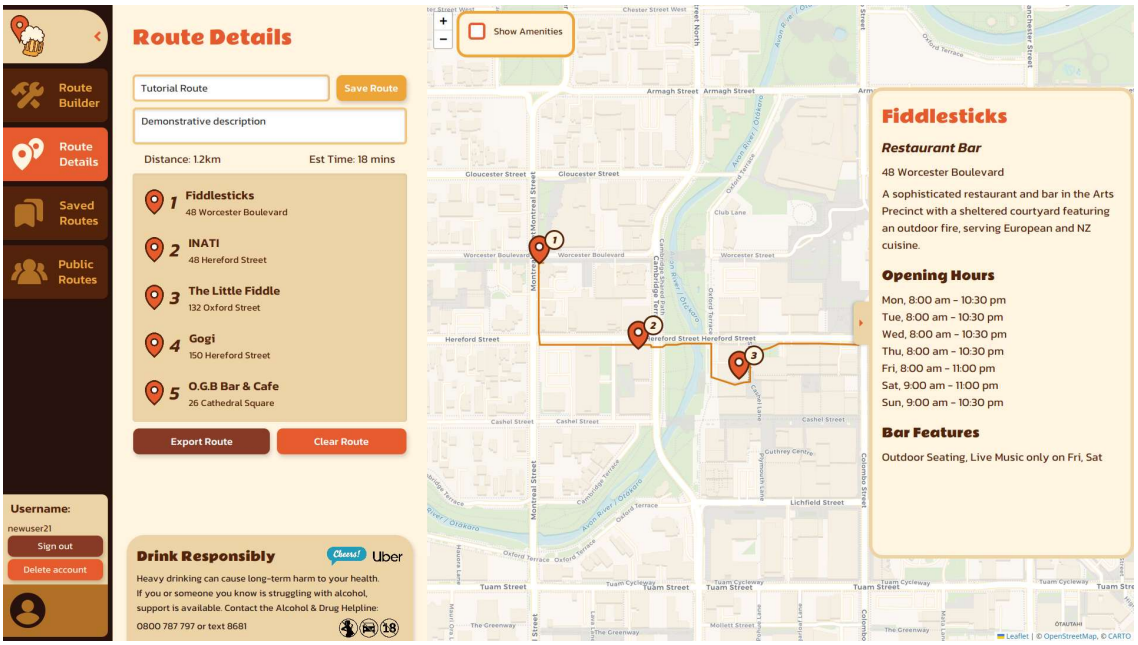


Figure 7: Bar information panel

You are probably thinking 'This is really cool, but what if I want to come back later and view I route I made earlier?'. Well, this is the feature for you.

The saved routes panel displays all your saved routes (if you are signed in as a guest, this will be empty and it will prompt you to sign in). Each saved route will be able to be deleted, published to public routes, and loaded into the map. Do this by pressing the corresponding button at the bottom of the route card (Figure 8).

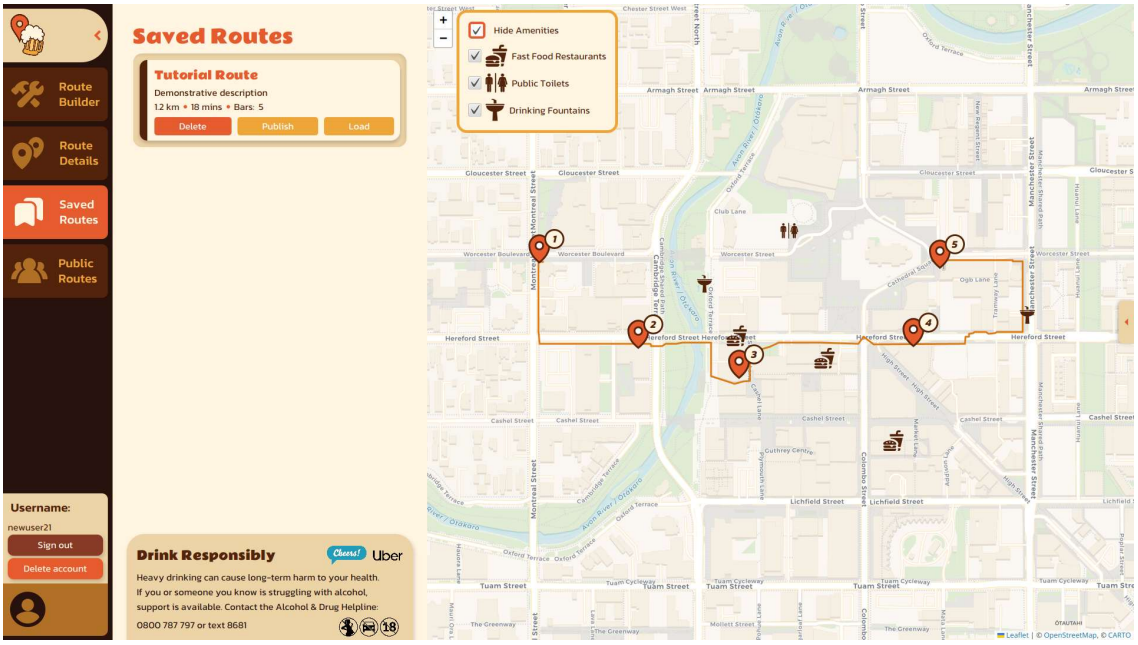


Figure 8: Saved Routes tab

Browse and rate routes

Navigating to the ‘Public Routes’ tab on the left side of the screen, click on this tab and it will take you to a similar layout to your saved routes, but with a whole bunch of different routes. These are routes published by other user for the enjoyment of the Route Beer community as seen in Figure 9.

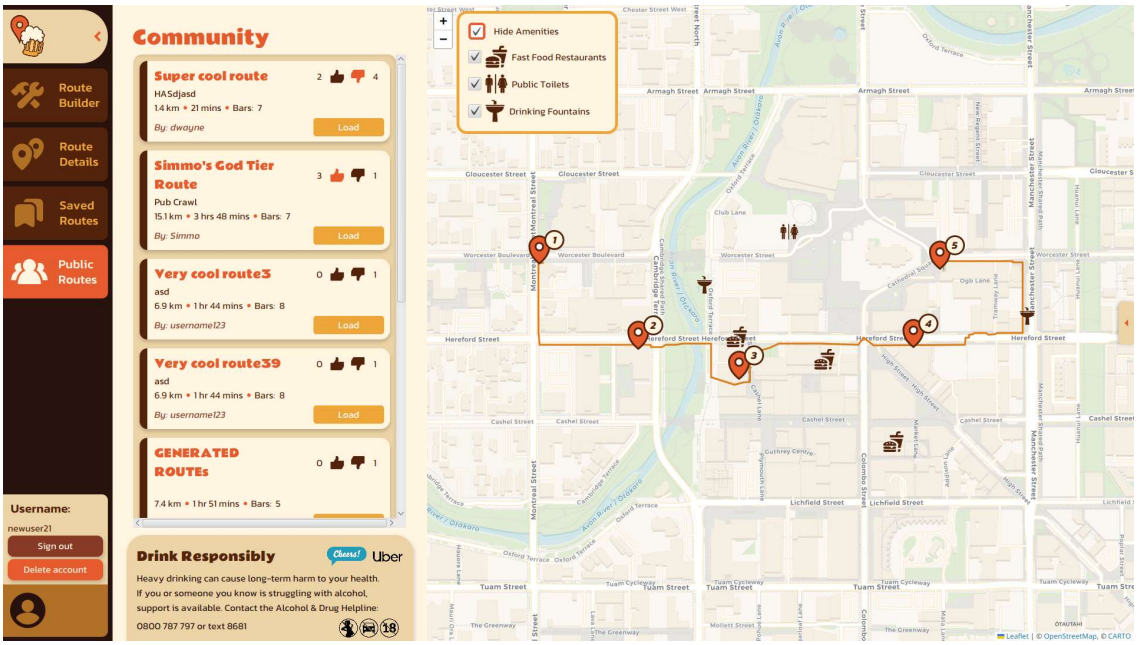


Figure 9: Public Routes tab

Each of these routes can be loaded onto the map just like one of your saved routes. This allows you browse around and view what other cool routes other people are creating with Route Beer, as seen below in Figure 10. Another thing you can do with these public routes is rate each one a thumbs up if it’s a good route, or thumbs down if it is not as seen previously in Figure 9. These allow all the other users to get a gauge on what the community thinks about each route and can get inspired to try out certain start bars or other route generation features. Once you rate a route, it is not necessarily permanent, you can always go back and change or remove your thumbs up or thumbs down.

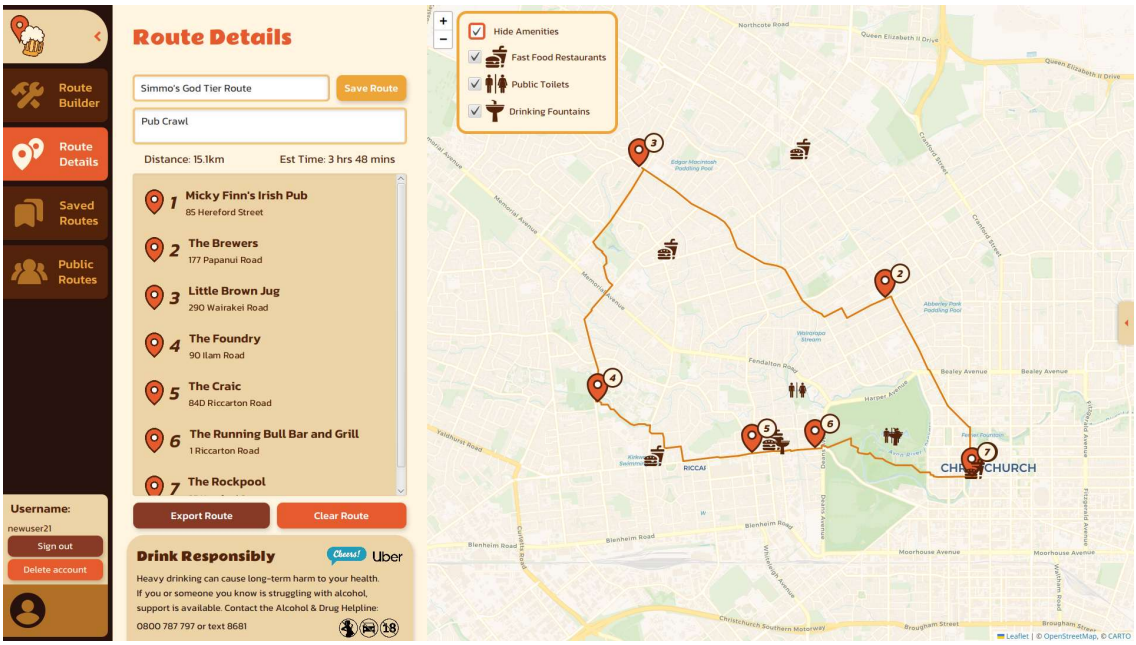


Figure 10: Route loaded from Public Routes

Export routes

The final key feature about Route Beer is being able to export your route to an image file. When you have a route generated or loaded from saved or public routes, there is a brown ‘Export Route’ button, as seen previously in Figure 10. Click this, and a preview of your exported route will show in the application. This will be a snapshot of your route from the map, along with its name, description, and list of bars in the route as seen in Figure 11. If this is something that you find cool, but want to return back to the app, click the orange ‘Cancel’ button in the top right hand corner of the screen.

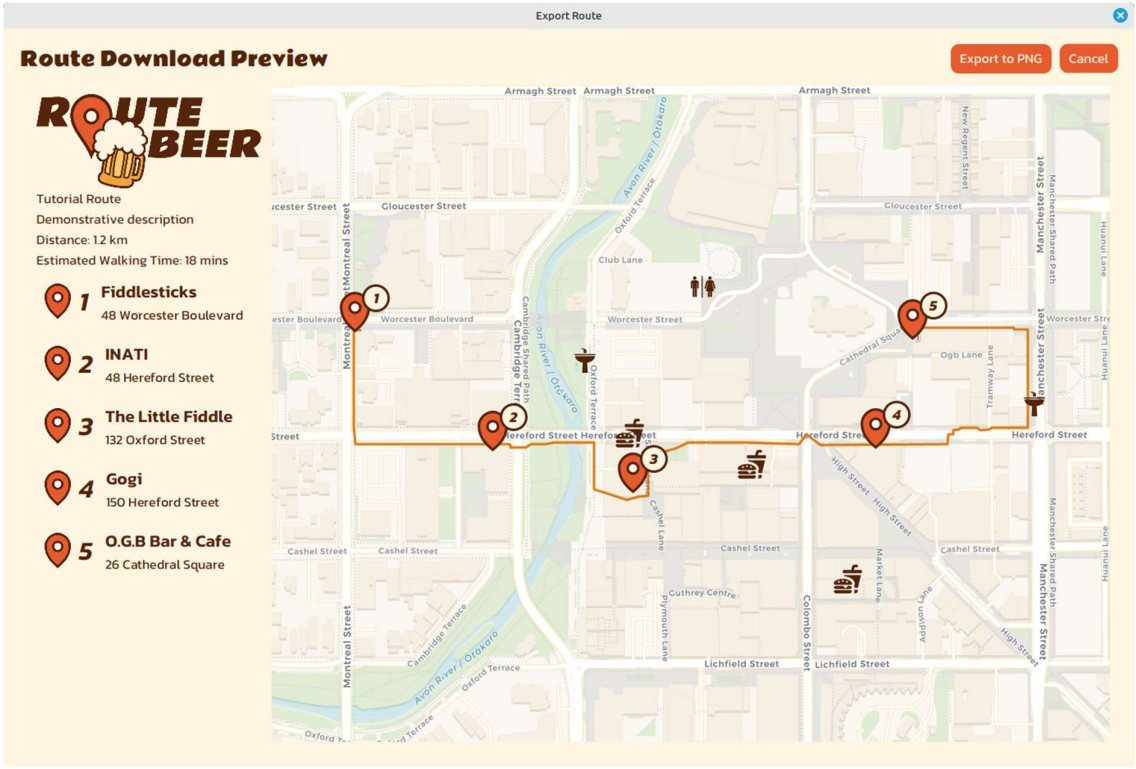


Figure 11 - Export Route preview

If you wish to export your route, click ‘Export to PNG’ in the top right of the preview. This will bring up a file picker for you to choose where to download your route to in your computer. The default name will be the name of your route but it can be changed at your discretion. Once you select your file destination and confirm, you will receive an app alert that you successfully exported your route and can continue with your Route Beer fun.

An example route image is seen here in Figure 12.

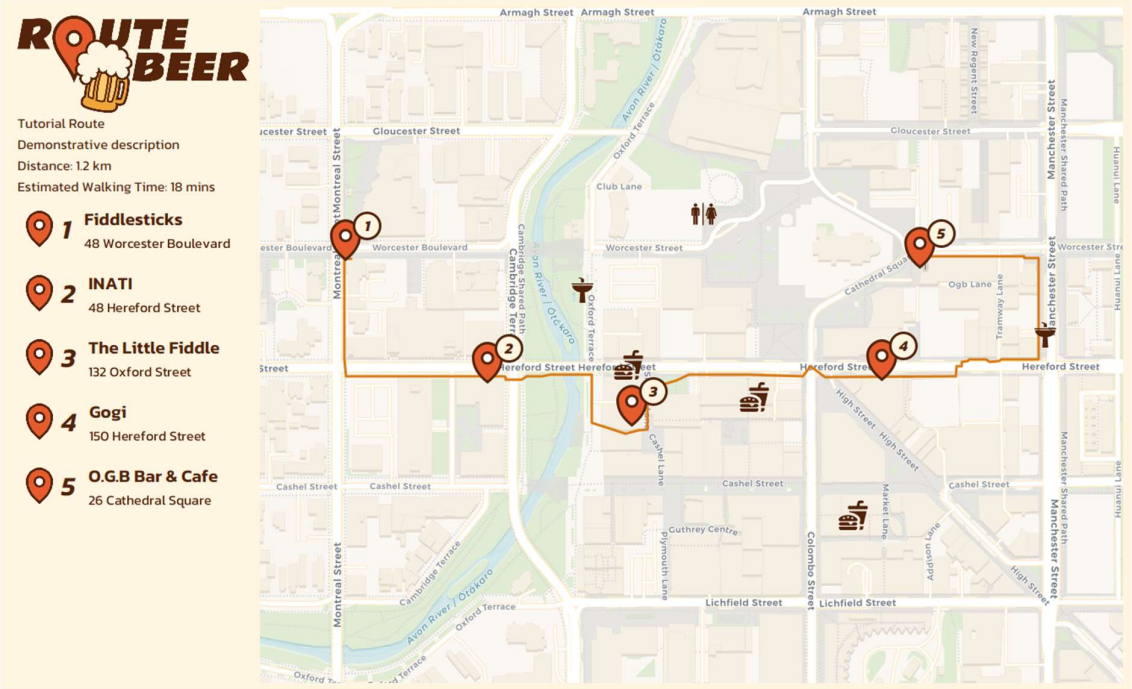


Figure 12 - Exported image of route

These exported routes can then be sent to your phone or other devices to take along with you on your bar crawl.

Closing Remarks

You are now ready to use Route Beer to its full extent! From signing in, to generating, saving, deleting, and publishing your own routes, browsing and rating routes that other members have shared, to exporting your favourite routes, you are ready to explore Christchurch! Please remember to drink responsibly, look after your friends, and never drink and drive. And most importantly... **Plan Your Pints**!